MCM 202 - Lecture 1: Introduction to Editing and Graphics in Journalism

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Transcript 1

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Lesson Video

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Transcript Text

Hello. Good day, wherever you are watching this from. Good day. Good day to you all, and you're welcome to the foundations of editing and graphics. On this channel of editing and graphics in communication. So, my name is Ola, and this part in this area, I've got over 8 years of experience as a practitioner designing books, and I'm also publishing the same. So, in this part of Ola lectures, I'll be taking you through the series of concepts taught, and also hands-on training on how to navigate your way towards understanding this entire course. Please open have an open mind, and it is very important that you are with your pen, your pens, your pencils, you know, your

notebook, your notepad, and be ready to do some research along as I teach this course.

Right. Just before we begin, would you please take a moment to scan this QR code to check yourself in. Yes, this is a way of you showing that you are here, and you truly are of this lesson. Do that now. All right. Do that now. Yeah. This is my face, but let's not face to mess myself, so you know who who is teaching you in this course. And yeah, just focus on the QR code and do the needful so we can move move on. Thank you. Thank you. Thank you. Thank you. All right. Let's move on. So, today I'll be introducing you to this particular program. And then, the idea of what we'll be learning about today. So, open your app and take a look at what we'll cover today.

In today's lesson, I'll be walking you through the definitions of editing and graphics, the scope of editing and graphics in the media, and also the historical evolution of the globe of editing and graphics within a global and Nigerian context. And as well, I'll be known leading you through to some roles of editing in media to ensure credibility, and of course, the concept of gatekeeping, the meaning of constructions of meaning will be will be also discussed in this. So, I'll say by the end of this particular video, you should be able to define editing and graphics in communication context. You should be able to explain the scope and functions of editing within various concepts. Be able to also to trace the development of editing and practice this globally, as well as in Nigeria, and analyze the role of editing in ensuring media credibility.

as well, you will have an a clear understanding as far the processes of shaping meaning using editing. So, let's begin. What is editing? Think about this. What is editing? You can put it in the chat if you have some idea before I share with you my definition, which you I expect you to put down in your notes. What is editing? Okay. Editing is the process of reviewing, is a process of revising, is a process of refining. And but what are you refining? You're refining content just before publication. So, we can put it together to say that editing is a process of reviewing, revising, and also refining content before they are published.

So, the purpose of editing is for you to have a thorough look at the content, have a thorough look at the the context of such content, and ensure that the intended meaning as originally conceived by the sender is, you know, improved so that the all the the audience, the receiver comprehend it. And it involves various corrections. Corrections of errors, improving clarity reasons, and also to ensure accuracy. When you edit, you add, and then you remove. When you are editing, you are ensuring that the content aligns with the editorial standard. We can as well call this the house style. And also, editing to ensure that it aligns with the audience expectation to ensure that your audience are able to comprehend the meaning that has been encoded into the channel.

Okay. The key functions of editing. What are these key functions? Think about it yourself. What are the key Why should we edit? Why should we edit a book? Why should we edit magazines? Why should we edit newspaper? Why should we edit videos? Why should we edit audios? Why should we edit even anything before it goes out there? You edit because you have a goal in mind. You have something you want to achieve. You have a meaning you want to share. You have an intent to convey a thought to the other party. So, you need to be sure that whatsoever you have said is put together removing all the noise, and ensuring that the message is kept when delivered. So, you edit because you need to correct.

You correct grammars, you correct spellings errors, you correct correct syntax errors. What are syntax? Syntax is structure. Spellings are you know what that means. That's the missing letters, placement of letters, or in fact, grammatical errors itself. All right. Spelling can be correct, but it may be incorrect within the context. For instance, writing for a British standard publisher, you're you're using American English. So, you can edit to correct spelling, and edit to correct it within a specific context. You can edit for clarification, meaning that you are editing to ensure that the meaning and the structures are clear. The next thing is that you can edit for verification, ensuring that the facts are truly factuals, and that they are accurate.

They are not misleading. So, you don't misinform. You also edit to ensure that there is standard. Standard in terms of style, in terms of formatting, what I earlier referred to as house styles. Now, when there is consistency, you are setting a mean a standard. You are trying to maintain a minimum standard that your readers should be familiar with. This standard is psychological, sometimes

physical, is set, and it is defined. And when you do this, you are building a brand. Standard is required for branding. Standard is required for branding. When you are editing, you can edit to suit a brand. You can edit to suit a purpose. You can edit for generic reasons.

You can edit for audience reason. You can edit to repurpose in whatsoever context. Have a goal in mind because you need to have a clearly defined goal in order for you to achieve your goal as an editor. Okay. Let's move to the other component. Remember, this is editing and graphics. So, we've tied the aspect of editing. Now, let's take a look at the part of graphics. It's a different concept. So, what is graphics? Put it in the chat. What is graphics? Make an attempt. This is a way for you to think here a bit. Let your brain engage. When we talk about graphics, what comes to mind? Flyers? Banners? Infographs? Think about it. Graphics. Okay. Graphics refers to any sort of visual elements used to communicate information.

This include images, it includes illustrations, it includes charts, it includes diagrams. And of course, layout. If you want to know more about layouts, there's another another course which you can, you know, you click on the card above if you're interested in that. It's It's a course on layout design, manuscript layout design. But in this particular course, we're focusing on editing and graphics. So, graphics refers to visual elements used to communicate information. This could be in form of images, in form of graphics, in form of illustrations, in form of charts, in form of diagrams, in form of layouts. And I often say that we needs to know what images are.

We needs to know what pictures are. We needs to know what illustrations are. We needs to know what charts are. We needs to know what diagrams are. We need to know what colors are and how they communicate. You can use colors to communicate. You can use pictures to com- communicate. You can use images to communicate. You can use photographs to communicate. You can use diagrams to communicate. You can use map charts to communicate. And you can even use layout to communicate. Okay. Let's deal with something about images and photographs. And then ill- and I'll say pictures. What is images? What are they? What are images? Sorry.

What are photographs? What are pictures? Do you think they're the same or they're different? Do your research. The first person to get the answer will earn a special points. All right. I'll come back to this later. Let's move on. Let's talk about functions of graphics. Graphics enhances understanding beyond texts. Graphics sort of add explainers that imagination. Put a picture to it. I'm giving you a clue there. It's enhances understanding. And it's also help attracts audience attention. And third is that it simplify complex information. You can imagine a large chunk of data being put into bar chart. That's summarizing it.

Simplifying it. For easy and quick grasp of communication. Presenting it in percentage. And again, it helps to support storytelling. It helps to support storytelling. Now, you can imagine when you're editing and you're editing graphics for effective Now, you should have a sense of how these two work together. Just before proceeding my teaching, attempt this quiz. In the In the early print era, the primary purpose of editing was what? Was it to entertain readers? Was it to correct physical and textural errors? Was it to promote political ideas? Or was it to just design page layouts and more? Okay. A quick one. Way back in history, they had reasons to print. And I will say they had reasons to create impression.

I will use the word impression. And these impressions are carved out on a particular surface and then some set of ink put on these and then they place it on on on the print area. And by so doing, we come about the name impression because it's creating impression. When you stamp your feet on the floor, you're creating an impression on the floor. And then your footprint will be made. Now, think about this and attempt this. In the early print era, the primary purpose of editing was what? Was it to correct physical textural errors? Was it to design page layouts or to promote political ideas or to entertain readers? The answer here is to correct physical and textural errors.

Remember when you make impression, you have textural details and it's very physical. So, the first stage was what? To create an impression. And impression if it's physically visible. All right. Let's move on to the to the scope of editing in the media. Oh. Okay. There are different scopes. And it's it cut across different domains. So, when you're editing for for print, it's different from when you're editing for for broadcast. When you're editing for print, for instance, even within print

itself is different when you're editing for newspaper is different from when you're editing for magazine is different from when you're editing for online is different from when you're editing for newsletters is different from when you're editing for bulletin.

It is different different context. It's different from when you're editing for flyers. It's different from when you're editing for editorials. It's different from when you're editing for opinion pieces. It's different from when you're editing for features. So, there must be a different scope. It's different from when you're editing for books. So, editing operates across multiple domains. The same for broadcast is different when you're editing for audio for radio. And when you're auditing for editing for radio, you're editing to maximize time and to ensure that you're communicating effectively. It's different from when you're editing for video. And when you within the audio, when you're editing for a magazine program is different from when you're editing for news is different from when you're editing for advert.

You can see these things are all sort of connected and then it's as a pictorial diagram that they are all under each other and then they have their specific context. So, you needs to understand this. Now, if you're editing for video for a live broadcast, when you see a video and then you see graphics of giving information about the name of the person being presented, what is happening, or you see live live news breaking and then it's animated showing. All of these are graphics. Or you see info graphs about maps and then during the COVID time you see red color coding, gray, and then you see white, you see amber colors. These are all editings. You see how important this course is. Editing and graphics in communication. I'll say editing and graphics for effective communication.

All right. Let's go. Print. In print, you edit for context. For example, in newspapers, magazines, books, or online. For broadcast, you edit for context and scope within TV or radio. And for digital, you edit for website, for logos, and social media. And there are different kind of social media and they have different formats and templates. When you're editing for TikTok, it's different from when you're editing for LinkedIn, it's different from when you're editing for your websites, it's different from when you're editing for Instagram. Instagram uses square for posts. And then for story, you use one That's is 1920 by 1080. That's the dimension.

And when doing that for YouTube, you do direct opposite of that. You edit for vertical, you edit for horizontal. You needs to know the differences. When you're also editing for advertising and PR, large board billboards, you know, special surfaces like street sign, you know, walls, vehicles, windshield, that's different kind of editing. Editing So, for for for out the advert that's you know, that that that that is displayed on the train, you needs to know the context and what material it is. Know how to communicate because train is moving. Think about the typeface, the styles, and more. Copy materials, branded content editing. To brand. I hope you're taking this in.

Take it in slowly. Take notes. Process the information you're taking. Whenever you have questions, put it in the chat. I'll actively respond to them. These are the scopes of editing. Next on my slide is the types of editing. What kind of editing do we We have copy editing which focuses on editing for grammars, for punctuations, and for styles. You look out for grammatical errors. You look out for punctuation error. You look out for stylistics error. Okay. Now, we also have substantive editing which focuses on more bigger content like structure, the content organization. It's more holistic. Substantive editing. And then we have the proofreading, which is the final error checking before publication.

Now, let I want to make it a quick distinction between copy editing and proofreading. Copy editing comes before the layout is done, and proofreading comes after the layout has been done, but before publication. If you want to know more, check the card. There is a full course on manuscripts, layouts, developments, and and related matter. Copy editing, more. All right. We also got visual editing, which is the selection and refinement of images for effective engagement and communication. And now, I'd like to take you through the historical evolution of editing globally and and of course within the context of Nigeria. I would like you to pay attention more carefully because we'll be doing this in a very interesting way.

Now, I'm going to be taking you right out. I'll ask you to imagine that you're stepping into a printing workshop in the 1500 century. And the room is dim. The air is thick with with with ink and

metals. The printer stands over a roll of tiny metal letters, arranging each one one after the other, piece by piece. Letter A goes there, B goes there. If you want to spell K, you have a particular metal for K. You have a particular metal for E. You have a particular metal for Y. And they have to be arranged in a particular order in that inverse way so that when you place it on the surface with the ink impression, you you have an Yeah.

You You have an impression. Now, your printer stands over the rolls of tiny metal letters. They're arranging each one by hand, and there is no delete. Mhm. No delete key. You missed it, you missed it. No spell check. No undo buttons like you have today. Every word must be physically constructed, each and every word. And And this is where editing begins because the You can't do that afterwards. You can't delete. You can't, you know, backspace. You can't press delete. You can't spacebar. It has to be done accurately right from the concept. Okay. What does this look like? It is a professional task that has been entrusted to professionals who are patient, who knows what they are doing, who try as much as possible to spend their time to ensure that what's is published is correct and error-free.

And they do this right from the moment of typing. That's exactly where editing began. Not a sophisticated profession, but a necessity. If a single letter was misplaced, the entire meaning could collapse. Proofreading at this stage was not about style. It was not about clarity. It was about survival of meaning. One mistake could mean reprinting an entire page, and at a very great cost. And the entire point is that the early print era established the first principles of editing. Number one principle is precision. And it matters because errors are expensive. Now, I want you to move forward to the 18th century. And the 19th century.

Newspapers began to emerge as a powerful and social institutions. Informations were no longer statics. They They're now dynamics. They're dynamics into into the play. It is timely, political, and influential. When a shift comes new needs. As we evolve, there were new needs. Sometimes we Sometimes someone must take action to ensure that these needs are met. And this takes responsibility to publish what is right. And someone must take responsibility for what is published. This is the birth of the editor as a role. So, the person who takes that responsibility is the editor. Editors are no longer just correcting errors. They are making decisions. They are ensuring that what becomes the news, what makes it to the public, is newsworthy.

So, they ask questions such as, "What is newsworthy? What should be published? What should be suppressed? " Editing becomes a position of authority. It becomes something quite significant that one person can decide what many others, you know, It moves from the printing table to the center of public life. The editor becomes a gatekeeper. And that's what leads to gatekeeping theory of the media. They are the gatekeepers of information, and by extension, the shaper of public opinion because whosoever that keeps the key the gate determines what goes in, what goes out. And what goes in determines what you know. What comes out determines what shape the public.

Okay. I've put I'm putting this into an organization now. In the early print era, we have manual typesetting and proofreading. Following that, we had the rise of newspapers, formalizing editorial roles. Then we have the 21st the 20th century with professionalism, the professionalization of journalism. And we have the digital era where we have real-time editing and online publishing as we have it today. Okay. Let's take a breath. What major development led to the formalization of editorial role? Is it the invention of radio? The use of social media? The rise of newspapers? Or the development of photography? Attempts this. Is it? Could it be invention of radio? Social media? Rise of newspapers? Or development of photography? Okay.

And my answer is the rise of newspapers. By now, you should know that that is the answer. Okay. In Nigeria, this is another phase of story. Within our context, let's bring it home. Imagine in the 19th century that the printing press arrived not just as a neutral tool, but as an instrument of influence. The missionaries, they began circulation of materials. They were using sprints to spread religious ideas and Western education. And the first newspaper was built in 1859. It's called Iwe Irohin Fun Awon Yoruba ati Egbe. That is a newspaper for the Egba people and the Yoruba people. At this stage, editing serves a very specific purpose, preservation of message.

They wanted to introduce Christianity. They wanted to teach people how to read and write. But beyond

that, there are underneath underlying meaning. But I would keep it at that for the purpose of this lecture. When you advance to higher level of courses like doing issues in Nigerian mass media, history of Nigerian mass media, political communication, you'll see that beyond the surface of Western education and transmission of religious ideas, there were ideological and economic influence. And there But at this stage, editing serves a very specific purpose, which is the preservation of the message. And this contents, they are controlled, they are structured, they are aligned with missionary agenda. Now, you are You're getting what I'm saying. It There's an agenda behind the whole thing. But something begins to change.

As the colonial period progresses, Nigerian voices begin begin to emerge in print. People start contributing. Newspapers became a tools of resistance and political awakening. Editing was no longer just about correcting, it was about you know, advocacy, about nationalism. We have people like Nnamdi Azikiwe, Obafemi Awolowo, now contributing to the story. Having their own newspaper house and using the press press home their agenda. Editors were not just professional, they were now becoming activists. They were becoming intellectuals, were becoming political actors. They asked, "How do we frame our reality? How do we construct this message to get the best of meaning and engagement? How do we challenge the colonial narrative? " Then, editing in this area in this particular era, in this particular season and point in history became a form of power.

So, if you're an editor, you've got power. So, the way a story is written and presented can influence the national consciousness, can have influence how people understand. There is this a theory in communication called framing theory. And we also have priming. We have agenda setting. Well, coming after independence, the Nigerian press expanded rapidly. Newspapers multiplied. Media houses grew in sizes and influence. Editing became more structured. Newsroom developed formal processes. And there became There are now roles like sub-editors, line editors, so that sub-editors could handle copy requirements and ensure that editorial standards were sort of stabilized.

So, this period represented a a time and season of growth and institutionalization. Editing is now part of an organized media system, not just for individual efforts. Okay. I hope you're following. We're at the colonial press area, where the missionary and the nationalist publication was the talk of the town. Then we have the post-independence expansions of newspaper industry. And following that, we had the military. The military. Editorial control and censorship came into place. So, the military season was sort of more complex because it was a complex time. Editing operated under pressure. Citizen- Citizenship was a thing of I don't know. You just have to protect yourself as a citizen. Censorship became a reality.

Certain stories cannot be published. Certain words cannot be used. Editors must navigate the risk carefully, otherwise they they risk the chances of being imprisoned, persecuted, sometimes maybe killed. In this context, editing becomes strategic, become conscious and sometimes coded. So, the headline, a phrase, or even the placement of a story can carry hidden meaning. So, editors are now learning how to communicate within the constraints. This period sort of teaching us the importance of editing and also an important lesson that editing is not always free. It is shaped by political and institutional power. Editing is not independent and it is shaped by our thoughts, our reasoning, our our background, our our interests.

So, now consider a contemporary era where Nigerian media landscape has transformed again. Digital platforms have been disrupted by the traditional publishing have have have disrupted the traditional publishing approaches and anyone with a smartphone can produce and distribute content. Editing now faces new challenges like speed over accuracy, viral content over verified information. And then, we have audience pressures and algorithm influence at different times. We have opportunities expanding. Independent media platforms, I imagine. Investigative journalists are gaining visibility. Diverse voices are entering into public discourse. And editing today must be balanced. We must think about professionalism.

We must think about technological tools that we use and how they are shaping and influencing our communication processes and meaning constructions. We must think about the audience expectations, too. Let me offer you a concrete example. A growth of a national newspaper reflects some institutional maturity, right? And then there the rise of an independent digital platform reflects democratization of media. And of course, social media reflect decentralization of editorial control.

But, there's something critical that I need to ask you. Which Nigerian media organization do you follow? Do you trust them? Why do you trust them? And why don't you? Have you noticed poor editing in any news story before? Have you noticed them using the wrong photos for the wrong story or manipulating previous story because they want to send a message? When you start asking yourself this question, you are engaging.

This shifts you from being a passive listener or consumer of information to an active reader and active reflection. So, one thing I want you to take home in this historical context is that editing in Nigeria is not just a technical process. It is shaped by history, by politics, by technology, by society. Don't forget the phases. Don't forget the phases. Colonial press era, post-independence era, military era, contemporary era, and like I've shared with you, the growth of national dailies, the rise of independent media voices has shaped things. Okay. Thank you for listening. And I want you to understand this that there is a connection between all of these things.

So, where globally, whether globally or even locally or in Nigeria, editing has always evolved in response to one central control, one central question. And that question is, who controls information? And how is it presented? This particular central question reinforces the transition into our next concept, which is editing as gatekeeping and meaning construction. But before we go on there, answer this question. During Nigeria's national news phase, editors were best described as Is it neutral observers, technical assistants, political actors and advocates or traffic designers? You should know this. Yeah? The answer is political actors and advocates. And then, don't forget this.

Like I've mentioned, missionary phase, nationalist phase, institutional phase, digital phase. What was the defining feature of editing during Nigeria's military era? Was it Was it complete freedom of expression, absence of newspapers, editorial control and censorship, or focus on entertainment entertainment content? You know that they were restricted. There was some censorship and this is editorial control and censorship. Now, why does editing matter? Without even presenting this slide, I think you should know by now that editing is central to accuracy of information. It is important for clarity of communication. It is important for professionalism.

It is important for for the the quality outputs and of course, to ensure that public trust is retained. Take note of this. Let's attempt this at another quiz. During the 20th century, editing became more professional due to what? A, reduced demand for news. Elimination of errors. Establishment of journalistic standards and ethics. Decline in media organization. And during the 20th century, editing became more professional due to what? The answer is C, establishment of journalistic standards and ethics. Okay. Editing as a defense against misinformation. I want you to And I've mentioned this earlier that if you don't edit, you are likely to misinform people.

Editing is a process of reviewing, adding and taking out, ensuring accuracy. So, editing will help you prevent errors like this. Such as presenting publications of false and misleading content. It will help you reduce errors, avoidable errors. It will help ensure that the content you're publishing is verified. It will help you make statements of what you were not clear of if you diligently go through it. It helps you verify the facts and the sources. It helps you reduce chances of being involved in litigation and legal charges or being sued to court. So, the key idea here is that poor editing can lead to reputation and damage or loss of trust.

Okay. Conceptual insight. I've introduced you to a few concepts, the concept of editing, the concept of of of graphics, and then now I'm mention the idea of gatekeeping. So, you have to think about editing as gatekeeping. So, this is on its own a concept. So, editors as gatekeepers means that they decide what content is published. They decide what content is rejected. They decide what content become the public knowledge. They influence which voice and perspective are amplified. And the implication of this is that editing shapes public discourse. It also acts as a filter for information. They determine what goes in or goes out. Let's answer this. Which of the following best describe editing in the digital era? Slow and manual, limited to print media, real-time and multi-platform, completely automated without human input.

The answer is real-time and multi-platform. Now, let's walk. I'll proceed ahead with editing, like I mentioned. This is another yet another concept. Editing as a meaning construction. Editing as meaning construction means that you are editing to shape and to redefine, to purpose the meaning.

Editing is not neutral, like I've mentioned. The choices of words, the structure, the visuals influences how the audience, the readers interpret the content. So, editing is not neutral. So, know this and don't forget it. Okay? Now, again, when I mean when I say it is not neutral, it means it is not totally free from influences. It means the way headline is constructed, the framing of the headline, the framing of the of the of the lead, the choice of image and the words, they are all influenced by something.

Editors do not just correct content, they shape the meaning. Okay. Think more about that. Let's have a case illustration of the same story, but of course giving us different meaning. One will give you a a neutral headline, the other will be a sensational headline. So, I would like you to answer this question. How does the editing How How How has it changed How has it changed the audience's perception in this context? Have a look. The first version of the headline says, "Federal government approved new education policy to improve digital learning in public schools. " And the version two says, "Federal government will roll out new education policy despite lack of computers in school.

" You know, these are the same the same story, but different meaning. The version one is neutral. Version two is sensational. Now, this is the version one, neutral. Same story, different meaning. Version two, sensational. Same story, different meaning. As an editor, well, in this case A, I can choose to use one, and I can choose to frame it, and I can frame it entirely another way. This is editing. Now, take a look at these two versions and answer the question. Answer the question. Don't forget, the question is how does editing change audience perception? These are the two headlines. The context is that a report states that federal government has approved a new education policy aimed at improving digital learning in public schools.

However, funding and infrastructure challenges remains. That's the context. All right. Now, to help you respond to this, I've put in this. Ask yourself these questions. Which headline would attract more clicks? Is it the first or the second? And why? Which headline builds more trust? Is it the first or the second? And why? If you are able to answer these questions, you will be able to answer the question. Now, the third one is which headline would a government spokesman prefer? Is it the first or the second? And why? Or could it be the answering the fourth question there. Which headline would an opposition prefer? Opposition voice prefer? Is it the first or the second? And why? Put your answer in the comment.

I'll stay here for a while. I've put an answer template in there. If you If you desire, you can of course if you know how to You know what to do, you can go outside of the frame. But the the structure should be In this case illustration, blah blah blah blah, ensure that you're writing full sentences. And don't just start with because. You notice that both headlines are based on the same underlying story. Hm? No fact has been changed, yet the interpretation shifts significantly. Okay. Pause the video as you are trying. Pause it. Version A presents the policy as a progress. It is a forward-looking and institutional-based. But version B is sort of signposting the limitation, introducing doubt and potential criticism.

So, this is showing that there is a critical principle that editing is not just about correctness. It is about the editor decides what it chooses to emphasize, what it chooses to downplay, what audience notices first. I won't give you all the answers to this. Put it in the comment. Put it in the comment. In my next lesson, I'm going to provide further details on this. All right. If you've done that, you've done excellently well. Well done. But attempting alone is a win. Okay. I'd like to give you another exercise in the appendix. In the next slide, I'll provide a short, poorly written news paragraph, and I'm asking you to identify the errors, suggest improvements, and I just want to introduce you to practical editing thinking.

So, here is the content. I want you to identify the errors in this slide. Suggest improvements. Pause the video so that you don't miss it. Okay, if you've done that diligently, well done. This is what you should have. After I did it. What has changed? What has changed? First, you see that there are some grammatical and everything errors there. We have the word the word announce. Which is the incorrect sort of tense. There there is planning. Just study it and you see that. When you say policy are focused, mhm. Doesn't make sense. Policy focuses on school does not.

It's a singular plural mismatch. Teacher is teachers is, no. Subject verb disagreements. Should be

teacher is or teachers are. Area is should be plural. We've got capitalization errors there. Study it, you see the errors. Punctuation errors there. Clarity and structural error there. Remember, it was one old chunk of paragraph. Now it has become different with a structure. Study this and know it. Okay, let's move on. I have decided to introduce AI tools in editing into this lecture for you to help you to understand how you can begin to use AI, you know, correctly. Think about this. AI is an assistant. It is not replacing you. What AI can do, well, it can can do grammatical and language corrections.

It can help with clarity and readability improvements. It is not good at initiating your original idea. AI can boost your speed and efficiency. AI can help you with basic content refinement. AI can help with headline suggestions, generating multiple lines for you to make a comparison and select the best one. But it is not you. Again, take note of these things and apply to every sphere of your learning. All of your assignments in school and outside of school. Your courses, your projects and more. You need to help you. Be in control of what you know and what you share, what you write, what you submit. AI cannot do certain things. Since it's not you, it cannot fact check with certainty.

It may generate or accept inaccurate information because it is online. AI cannot give you context because you only understand the context. AI doesn't live in your environment. Doesn't know the reality. AI doesn't know what is happening politically, socially, locally. It is you that know. That is where your voice should come in. AI can make editorial decision. AI can can can give you ethical ethical reasoning because it is a human thing. Ethics varies from places to places. Laws varies from places to places based on culture, based on tradition, based on what people agree. Based on democracy. AI cannot help you with meaning construction.

Cannot fully grasp the framing and I you I want to achieve this. Except you are a an excellent prompt engineer. Yet it's still not you. It's a computer. Okay. Now, practical examples of tools, AI tools that can be used for editing. Well, primarily which is which is you can have as a plugin, as an extension in your Word app or your Google Doc on your computer entirely. It can help with grammar and style corrections. We have ChatGPT which would help with rewriting and summarizing and headline drafting. And you have to be very careful with it. Be very careful with your data and what you input and what you put out. Sometimes you lose your voice because of doing these things. And we have Microsoft Editor which has suggestion function.

That's also AI part. So AI has been with us for a very long time. Way long before ChatGPT. It helps you improve speed, surface level quality, but human editor should always ensure that it is truthful, accurate, concise and it is credible. So these are the risks that you take when you deliver everything to AI. You will become over reliant leading to reduced human critical thinking. It leads to subtle errors that appears. All right, but they are misleading. It leads to loss of editorial voice and originality. It leads to potential bias embedded in the AI generated suggestion because what? Those who trained the with those knows what they put in. So you have to be very careful on how you use AI. And the core principle here is that AI assists the editor, but the editor remains responsible for accuracy judgment.

I mean, if you submit an AI generated content and you can't defend it, you can't explain it, you will be responsible and you pay for it. I'm asking you this. Have you ever used AI to write or edit something? Did you trust the output completely? Why did you trust it? And why didn't you? Okay. In today's lesson, we've been able to ensure clarity, accuracy and professionalism. I've taken you through the history and non-graphics enhance communication and engagement that editing evolves over and you can move from manual editing system like we've done over the over the course of history to digital that we are here now today. Editing plays critical role in what? Media credibility. Editing is also both gatekeeping and meaning construction.

So these concepts are key. That's why I was able to introduce artificial intelligence in editing and how to use it appropriately. So AI improve speed, surface level editing, but human editor ensures truth, context and credibility. Don't forget it. Here's an assignment for you. Find a new a recent news article. Identify the strengths, the weakness. And I'll be asking you to submit a one-page analysis. And if you check the description, you you'll find a guide on how to submit. There will be a form there where you can, you know, make your submission. So to bring this particular session to a close, the question time and then the check out.

Let's answer this question. Which of the following best capture the major shift in editing over time? From visual to textual communication, from manual correction to digital rapid and multi-platform editing, from newspaper to book only, from accuracy to creativity. Which is the answer? B. Yes, that is the correct answer. Now, please take your time to ask questions. Screenshot it if you can't, you know, directly engage it and then click on the barcode, the QR code it leads you to where you can ask questions. It's timed. Don't forget that. Ask questions, put in comments and then let's engage. All right, if you've done that, you've done really well.

If you've done that, you've done really really well. Well done for making it to the end of the lesson. And then I'm about like to also ask you and prompt you to do the most important thing beyond just your learning. Check out. Check out. Okay. All right, so on these notes, in our next session, next lesson, we will be looking at the newsroom workflow, the roles and responsibilities of sub editor and I'll be introducing you to the editing symbols. If you are curious to know quickly, you can move to the manuscript course where I have shared with you some I've shared on my YouTube channel some ways you can communicate editing without writing words by using signs. All right, if you've come to the end of this lesson, thank you so much and I'll see you in my next lesson.

Cheers and bye.

Check-out Form: Check-out Form: (click or scan; screen reader accessible)